

LittleReads

The Three Friends and the Broken Bridge

Friendship

Ages 6–8

by LittleReads Editorial Team

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Right now, they're pulling things off that nobody could have dreamed of doing 50 years ago, and that's of course a real challenge.

Chapter 1: The Broken Bridge

The three friends lived on one side of the Maji River. Their school was on the other side.

Every day, they crossed the old wooden bridge to get to school. It was old, but it worked.

Until one rainy morning, when they heard a terrible CRACK.

The bridge had broken! A huge section in the middle was gone, swept away by the rushing water.

"How will we get to school?" cried Chinwe.

"I will build a new bridge!" said Ibrahim, rolling up his sleeves.

"Let me plan how we should do it," said Folake, pulling out her notebook.

"I will help build it!" said Chinwe.

And so their adventure began.

Chapter 2: Ibrahim's Attempt

Ibrahim carried the biggest logs he could find and dropped them across the river.

"There!" he said proudly. "The bridge is done."

But the logs were not connected. When he stepped on the first one, it rolled, and SPLASH — Ibrahim fell into the shallow water.

"You need more than just strong logs," said Folake, helping him up.

"You need a plan."

"My turn next!" said Chinwe.

Chapter 3: Chinwe's Attempt

Chinwe tried to weave branches and vines together to make a beautiful bridge.

It looked wonderful, but when she tested it, the vines snapped and the bridge collapsed into the river.

"The materials are not strong enough," said Ibrahim. "We need wood and nails, not just vines."

"You are right," said Chinwe. "Beauty alone is not enough."

Folake sat down with her notebook. "Let me think about this properly," she said.

Chapter 4: Folake's Plan

Folake drew a careful diagram. She measured the width of the river. She calculated how many logs they needed.

"Ibrahim, we need your strength to carry the big logs into position. Chinwe, we need your creativity to weave a strong rope railing and make it safe."

"And you, Folake?" asked Ibrahim.

"I will make sure everything is in the right place and the bridge is safe to cross."

Together, they worked. Ibrahim carried the heavy logs. Chinwe wove strong railings from vines. Folake directed everything, checking each step.

By sunset, the bridge was finished. It was not as fancy as the old one, but it was strong, safe, and beautiful.

Chapter 5: Stronger Together

The next morning, the three friends crossed the new bridge together. It held firm under their feet.

"We did it!" said Chinwe.

"Alone, we could not," said Ibrahim. "Together, we could."

"That is the lesson," said Folake. "Ibrahim has strength. Chinwe has creativity. And I have planning. Alone, each of us fails. Together, each of us succeeds."

From that day on, the three friends were even closer. They had learned that friendship is not just about playing together — it is about combining your strengths to solve hard problems.

And the bridge across the Maji River stood strong for many years to come.

What We Learned

- Everyone has different strengths, and that is what makes teamwork powerful.
- Planning before acting leads to better results.
- Strength alone is not enough — it needs direction.
- Creativity and planning are just as important as physical strength.

Discussion Questions

1. What is your special strength?
2. When have you worked with friends to solve a problem?
3. Why did the bridge fail when each friend tried alone?

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Thank you for reading!

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